Experiment - 04

Data Modelling and Form Design for a Business Application in Zoho Creator

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AIM

To design and build a functional "Hotel Room Booking Form" application in Zoho Creator that demonstrates the correct usage of all thirteen Basic Fields available in the Form Builder — Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select, and Checkbox — and to model the underlying data structure of a real hospitality room-booking workflow through a properly sectioned form and an auto-generated report view.

PROCEDURE

1. Data Model Design

Before building the form, the data requirement was analysed and organised into a simple data model, grouping the thirteen Basic Fields under four logical sections that map to the stages of a guest's booking journey: Guest Details, Contact Details, Room and Stay Preferences, and Scheduling and Policy Acknowledgement. Every field submitted through the form flows into a single auto-generated report, Room_Booking_Report, which the front office uses to track and manage bookings. The resulting data model is shown below.

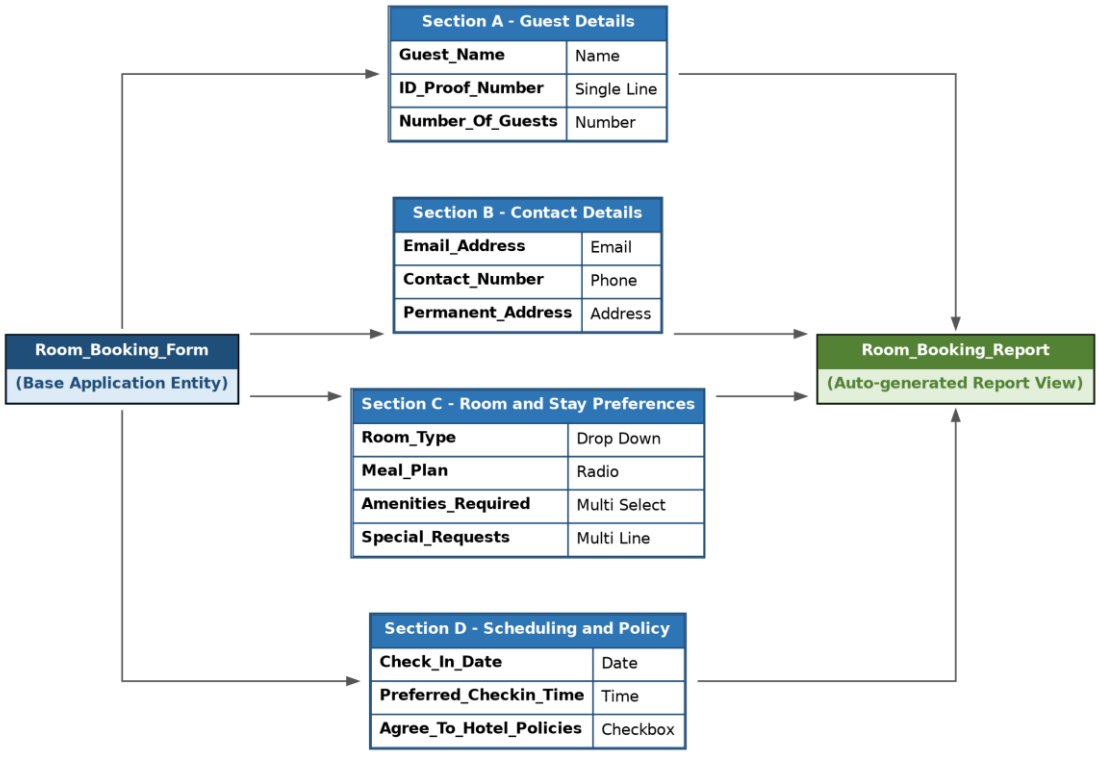


Fig 1. Data Model — Room_Booking_Form and its sectioned fields feeding Room_Booking_Report

2. Application and Form Creation

1. Logged into Zoho Creator and clicked Create New Application → Create from Scratch.

2. Named the application "Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Management" and confirmed creation, which opened the default blank workspace.

3. Inside the application, opened the Forms panel and clicked the + icon to add a new form, naming it Room_Booking_Form.

4. This automatically created a linked report, Room_Booking_Report, which will list every submitted booking request.

3. Drag-and-Drop of Basic Fields

In the Form Builder, the Basic Fields palette was expanded on the left panel. Each required field was dragged from the palette and dropped onto the canvas in the order needed, then double-clicked to open its Field Properties panel for renaming and configuration, as listed below.

Basic Field	Field Name Set	Drag-and-Drop Configuration
Name	Guest_Name	Dropped onto canvas; enabled First Name / Last Name sub-fields.
Email	Email_Address	Dropped below Name; enabled built-in email format validation.
Address	Permanent_Address	Dropped in Contact section; kept default Street/City/State/Country/Zip sub-fields.
Phone	Contact_Number	Dropped in Contact section; set country code format to India (+91).
Single Line	ID_Proof_Number	Dropped in Guest Details section; set as mandatory free-text entry.
Multi Line	Special_Requests	Dropped in Room & Stay section; expanded text area to 4 rows.
Number	Number_Of_Guests	Dropped in Guest Details section; range restricted to 1–6.
Date	Check_In_Date	Dropped in Scheduling section; past dates disabled via date-picker settings.
Time	Preferred_Checkin_Time	Dropped below Check-In Date; default time format kept as 12-hour.
Drop Down	Room_Type	Dropped in Room & Stay section; choices list populated with room categories.
Radio	Meal_Plan	Dropped below Room Type; three mutually exclusive options added.
Multi Select	Amenities_Required	Dropped below Meal Plan; multiple amenity choices added for multi-pick.
Checkbox	Agree_To_Hotel_Policies	Dropped in Policy section; marked mandatory so the form cannot submit unchecked.

4. Organising Fields into Sections

To keep the form guest-friendly and logically grouped, a Section field was dragged from the Layout palette above each group of related fields, and the dropped fields were dragged again to nest them under the correct section header. Four sections were created in this way:

- Section A — Guest Details: Guest Name, ID Proof Number, Number of Guests.
- Section B — Contact Details: Email Address, Contact Number, Permanent Address.
- Section C — Room & Stay Preferences: Room Type, Meal Plan, Amenities Required, Special Requests.
- Section D — Scheduling & Policy Acknowledgement: Check-In Date, Preferred Check-in Time, Agree to Hotel Policies.

Each section header was renamed by double-clicking it and typing the section title, and fields within a section were reordered using drag handles until the layout matched the intended guest journey from identity to policy acknowledgement.

5. Applying Field-Level Validations

1. Selected Guest_Name, Contact_Number, ID_Proof_Number, Number_Of_Guests, Room_Type, Check_In_Date, and Agree_To_Hotel_Policies one by one and enabled the Mandatory toggle in Field Properties.

2. Opened Email_Address properties and confirmed the built-in email format validation was active.

3. Opened Contact_Number properties and set the phone format to the Indian country-code pattern.

4. Opened Number_Of_Guests properties and set Minimum Value = 1 and Maximum Value = 6.

5. Opened Check_In_Date properties and restricted selectable dates to today and future dates only, disallowing past dates.

6. Confirmed under Agree_To_Hotel_Policies that the Submit button remains disabled until the checkbox is checked.

6. Preview and Deployment

1. Clicked the Preview icon in the Form Builder toolbar to view the live guest-facing form and verified that all four sections render in order with correct field types.

2. Filled and submitted three sample bookings through the preview/live form to test validations and generate report data.

3. Opened Room_Booking_Report from the Reports panel and verified that all submitted records appear with values mapped correctly to each field.

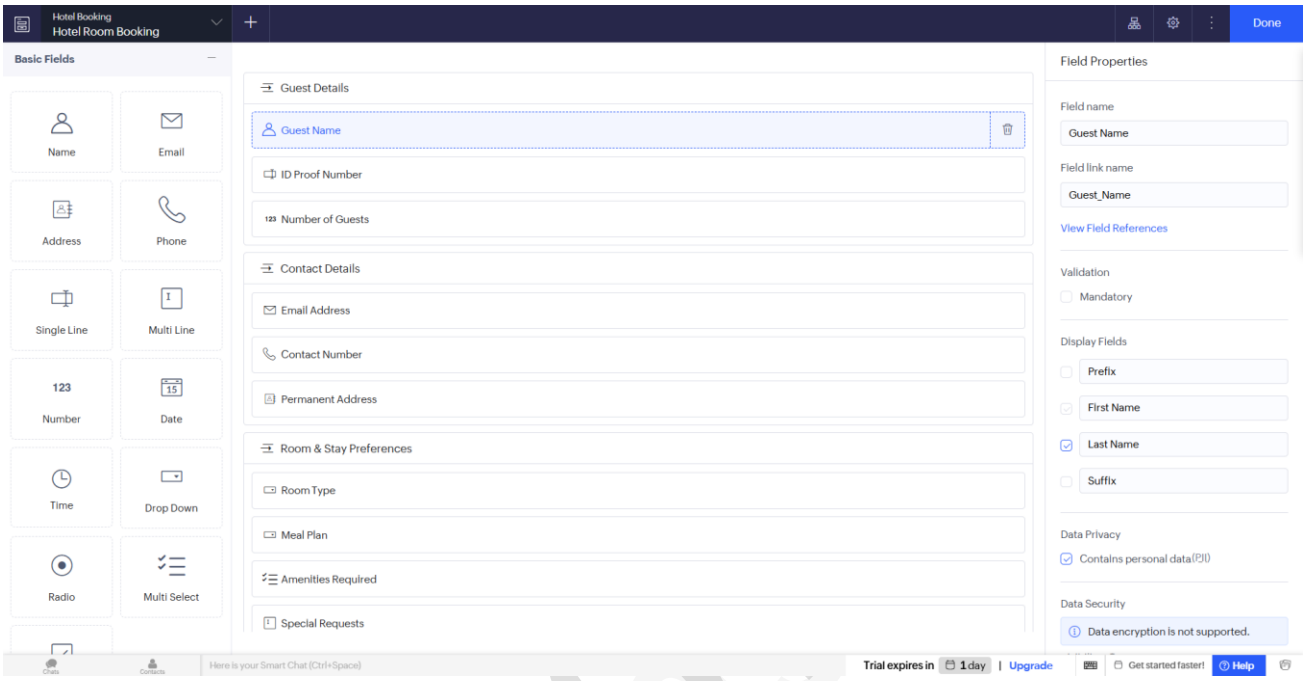
4. Applied a filter on Room Type and Check-In Date in the report view to confirm the front office can sort upcoming arrivals.

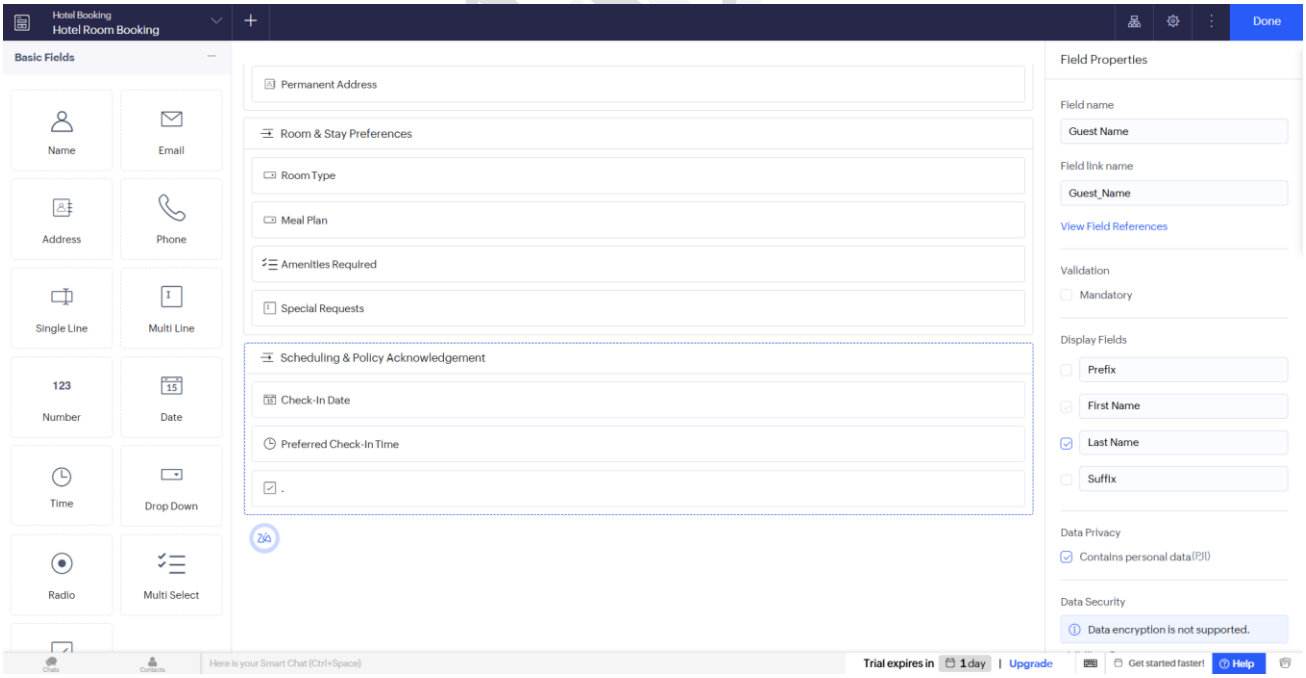
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OUTPUT

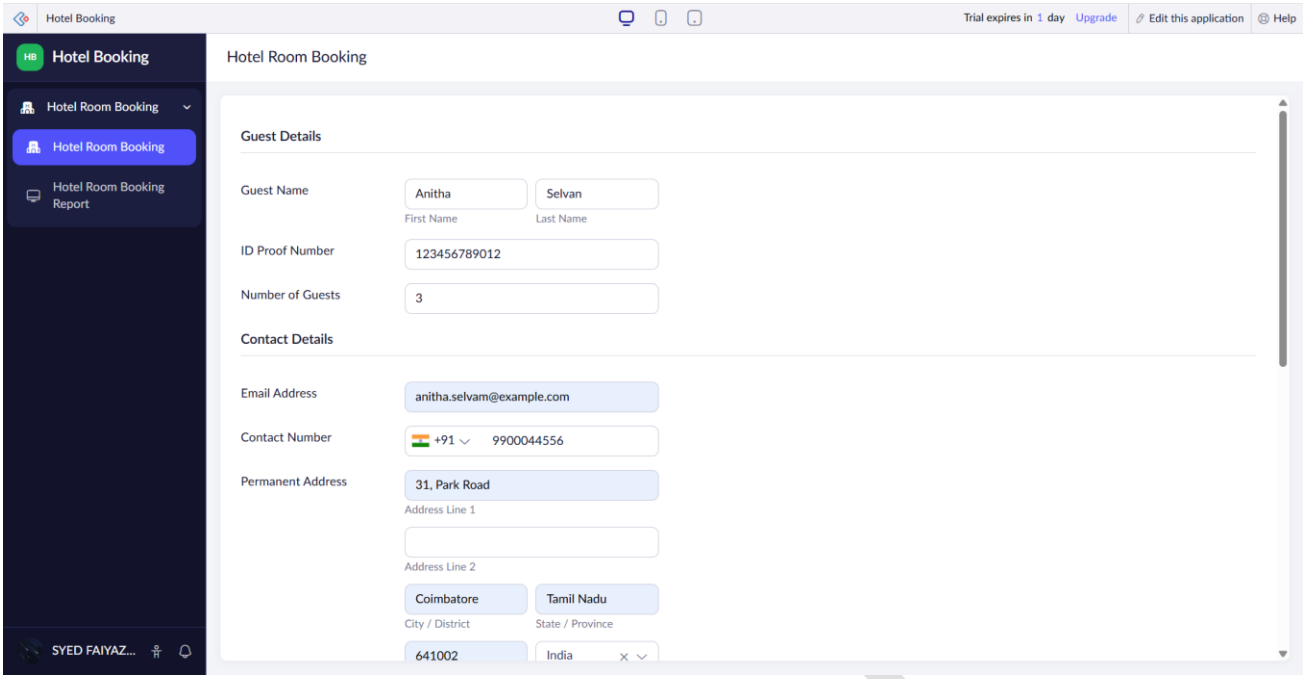
The following screenshots capture the completed application: the Form Builder showing all thirteen Basic Fields arranged into four sections, the live guest-facing form preview, and the Room_Booking_Report containing sample submitted records.

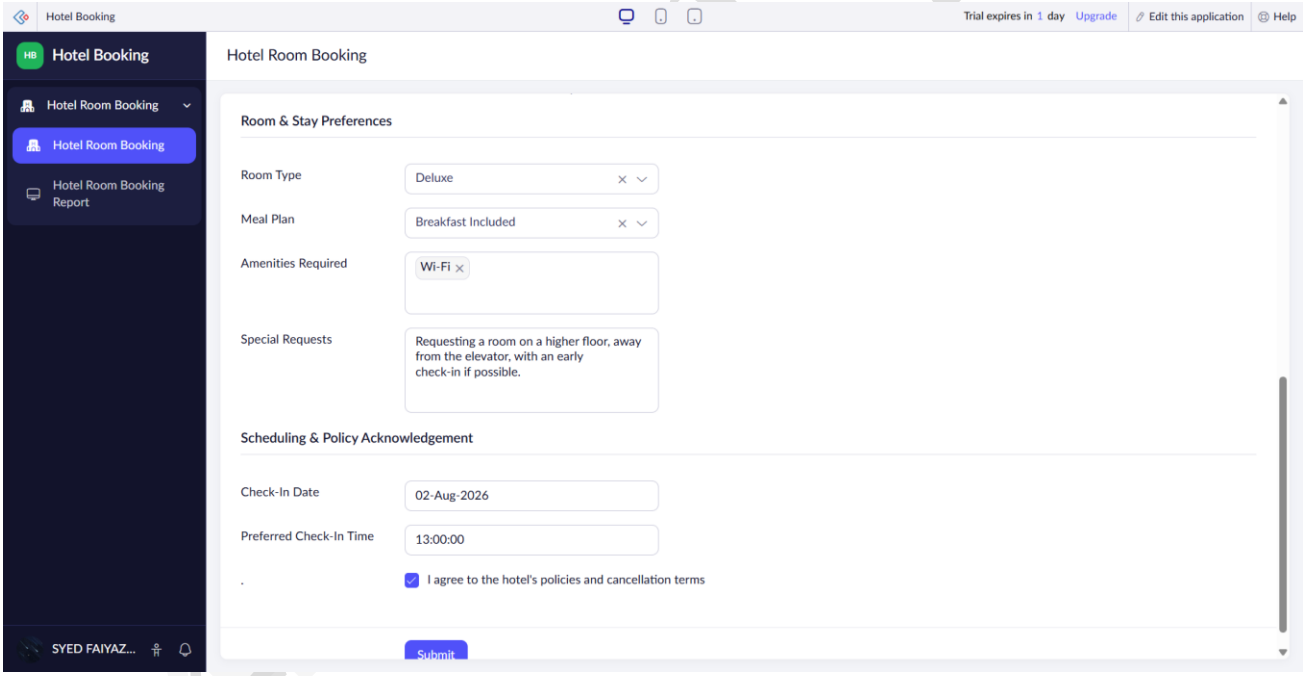
1. Form Builder View — All Basic Fields Placed and Sectioned



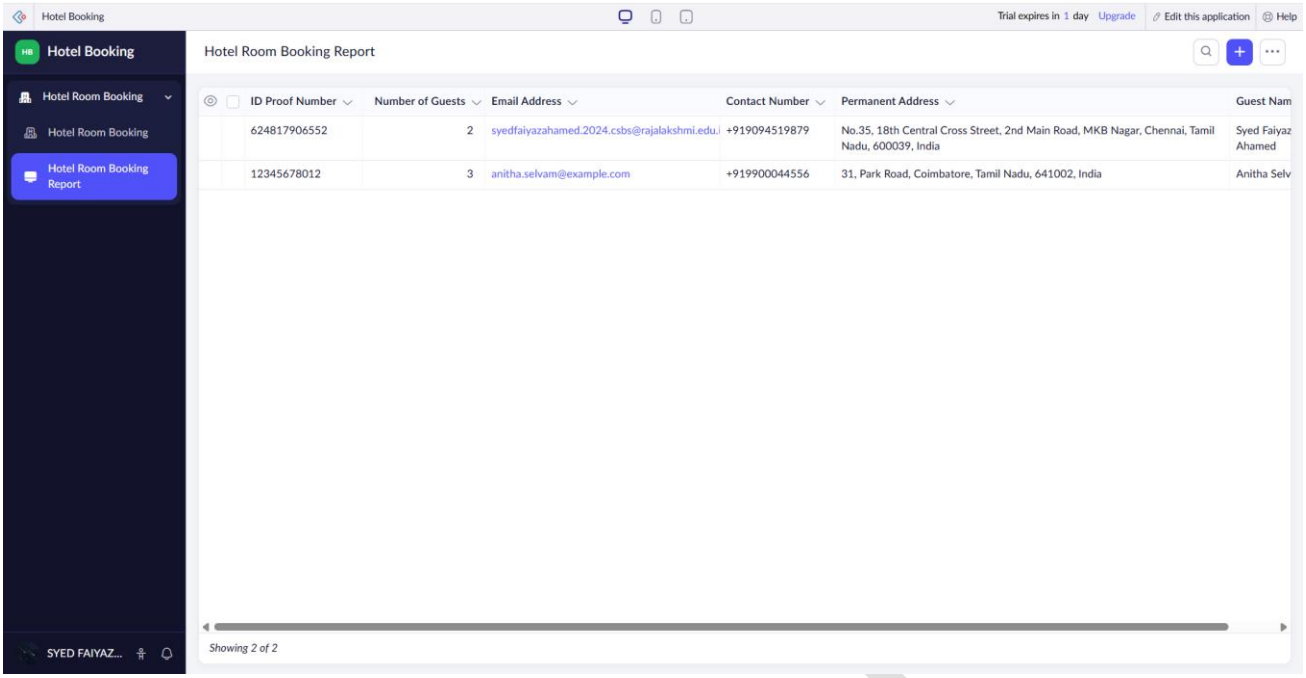


2. Live Form Preview





3. Room_Booking_Report — Sample Submitted Records



RESULT

A Hotel Room Booking Form application was successfully designed and built in Zoho Creator using all thirteen Basic Fields — Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select, and Checkbox. The fields were logically grouped into four sections through drag-and-drop, mandatory and format-level validations were configured successfully, and the Room_Booking_Report was verified to correctly capture and list guest booking data submitted through the form. The exercise thus demonstrated an understanding of data modelling and low-code form design for a real business use case.